

Transition to Adulthood Master Checklist

Check off each item as it is completed. Date every action. This checklist covers ages 12 through adult.

Child's Name _____

Current Age / Grade _____

State of Residence _____

Ages 12–14: Foundation

■	Get on state DD agency / HCBS waiver waiting list	Date: _____
■	Open ABLE account at ABLENRC.org	Date: _____
■	Begin vocational exploration (interests, strengths)	Date: _____
■	Start self-advocacy skill building in IEP	Date: _____
■	Research guardianship alternatives (supported decision-making)	Date: _____
■	Review IEP — add transition language to goals	Date: _____
■	Connect with other transition-age autism families	Date: _____

Ages 14–16: Building Toward Independence

■	First formal transition IEP completed	Date: _____
■	Student participates meaningfully in own IEP meeting	Date: _____
■	Community-based vocational experiences begin	Date: _____
■	Contact Vocational Rehabilitation (VR) — enroll	Date: _____
■	Research post-secondary options (college, vocational, day programs)	Date: _____
■	Begin financial planning: SSI projections, SNT planning	Date: _____
■	Meet with estate planning attorney — Special Needs Trust discussion	Date: _____
■	Explore guardianship alternatives with attorney	Date: _____

Ages 16–18: Active Transition

■	Transition IEP specifies: post-secondary ed, employment, independent living goals	Date: _____
■	Work experience with supports (school-based or community)	Date: _____
■	Vocational Rehabilitation plan in place	Date: _____

■ SSI pre-application planning completed	Date: _____
■ Apply for SSI at age 17 years 9 months	Date: _____
■ Adult medical team identified (pediatric → adult providers)	Date: _____
■ Tour adult day programs / residential options	Date: _____
■ Legal decisions made: guardianship / supported decision-making documents signed	Date: _____
■ Selective Service registration planned (males — required within 30 days of 18th birthday)	Date: _____

Age 18: Major Transition Points

■ SSI application submitted	Date: _____
■ Selective Service registered (males)	Date: _____
■ Legal decision-making documents in place	Date: _____
■ Healthcare transitioned to adult providers	Date: _____
■ College disability services registered (if applicable)	Date: _____
■ Representative Payee established (if needed for SSI)	Date: _____
■ Medicaid continuation confirmed	Date: _____

Ages 18–22: Final School Years (IDEA Through Age 21/22)

■ Maximize remaining school-based transition services	Date: _____
■ Paid work experience secured and supported	Date: _____
■ Independent living skills training program enrolled	Date: _____
■ Adult medical team fully established and functioning	Date: _____
■ Post-secondary placement finalized and started	Date: _____
■ Handoff from school to adult VR and DD services complete	Date: _____
■ Special Needs Trust funded	Date: _____

Ages 22+: Adult Life Systems

■ HCBS waiver services activated	Date: _____
■ Employment pathway established (supported, competitive, or self-employment)	Date: _____
■ Housing arranged (family home, shared living, own home, group home)	Date: _____

☐	Annual SSI review completed	Date: _____
☐	Community participation and social connections in place	Date: _____
☐	Annual review of ABLE account and Special Needs Trust	Date: _____
☐	Letter of Intent updated annually	Date: _____

Key Contacts & Agencies

State DD Agency Name & Phone

Vocational Rehabilitation Counselor

SSI / SSA Case Number & Phone

Special Needs Trust Attorney

ABLE Account Number / Plan

Adult Medical Provider (Primary Care)

Adult Psychiatrist / Behavioral Health
